

Research Report

Financial Health Score (FHS)

Feature in 'My Money'

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Interviews

& Testing

Contents

RESEARCH PLAN OVERVIEW

EXPERIENCE OF FHS

USER MENTAL MODEL

About Qualitative Research

Qualitative research (like this study) explores subjective experiences to understand the 'what', 'how' and 'why'.

	QUALITATIVE RESEARCH	QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH
Best for learning	-What do users...? -How do users...? -Why do users...?	-How many users...? -How much...?
Sample Size	-10 to 15 users	-100s and 1000s of users
Statistical significance	-No	-Yes

Sample Size in Qualitative Research

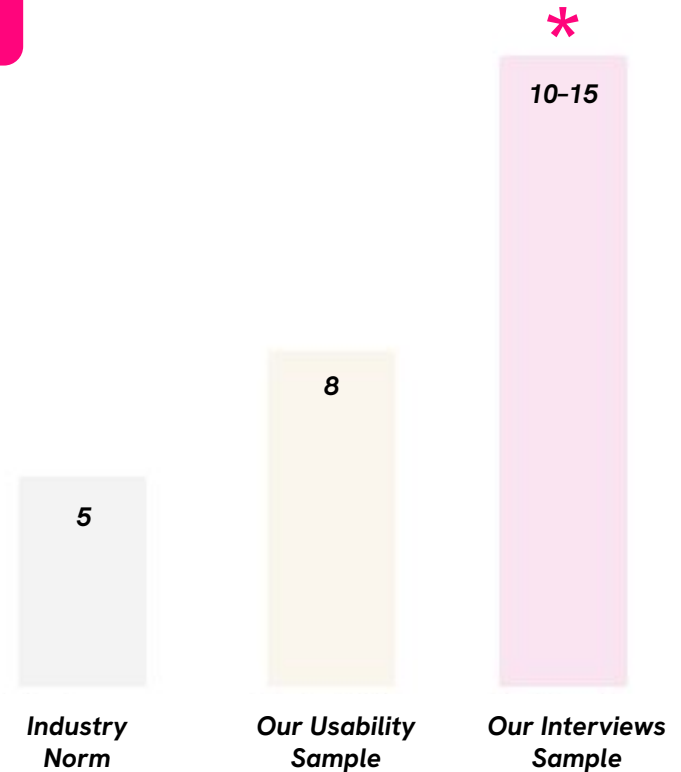
The industry norm for a usability test is to start with 5 participants.

However since our cohorts at Axis are often complex, we observe that we should start with 8 participants.

In the case of interviews, we observe that findings start getting saturated/ repetitive after 10-15 participants.

Qualitative Studies ≠ How Many

Reference: Nielsen Norman Group



Research Goal

Understand the experience of the revamped landing page

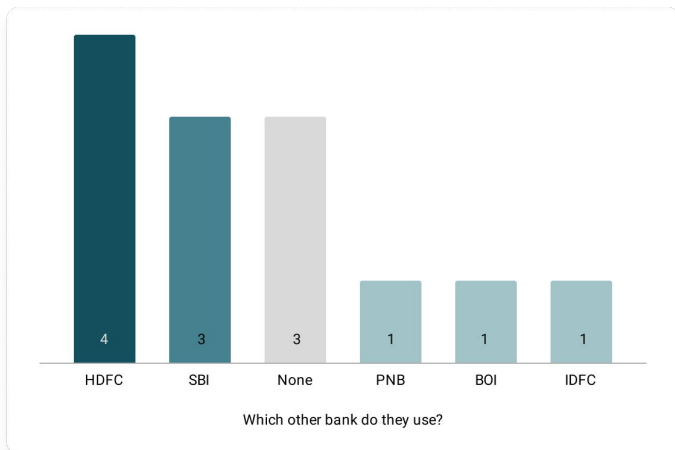
1. Gather expectations from a feature like FHS
2. Identify reasons for disengagement by people who have visited it
3. Assess understanding of FHS landing page and its various sections
4. Evaluate the comprehensibility of the FHS landing page and its various sections
5. Evaluate the usability of the FHS landing page and its various sections

User Profile and Methodology

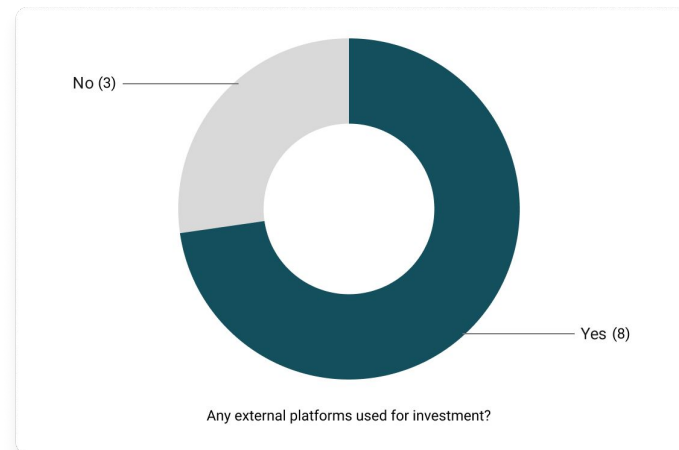
45 minute in-depth interviews and moderated user testing

S No	Name	Age	Location	Occupation	Open app usage	Axis Bank Products	Behaviour on FHS landing page	Score Type	Score
1	Abhishek Singh	42	Delhi	Software engineer	More than 2 times a month	Sending money Debit Card, Credit Card (rarely)	Clicked nothing	Urgent Attention	60.8
2	Akshit Shah	34	Mumbai	Steel Business Owner	More than 2 times a week	MF, UPI, SIP, Trading (Axis Direct)	Clicked something	Urgent Attention	47.2
3	Gaurish Arora	22	Delhi	Procurement Ops at Accenture	More than 2 times a week	UPI, Debit Card, Credit Card	Clicked nothing	Needs Improvement	63.2 (later 19)
4	Jignesh Khatri	40	Mumbai	Garments Business	More than 2 times a month	MF, RD, FD	Clicked something	Urgent Attention	42.4
5	Manish Mishra	27	Bilaspur	MIS Executive	More than 2 times a week	SIP for FD, RD	Clicked nothing	Needs Improvement	64.4
6	Mohit Jaisingh	34	Delhi	Deputy Manager at MNC	More than 2 times a week	UPI, Credit Card	Clicked something	Needs Improvement	63.2
7	Rohit Hariyani	37	Mumbai	Real Estate Consultancy Business	More than 2 times a week	UPI, Debit Card, Investments Credit Card (rarely)	Clicked something	Urgent Attention	55.4
8	Sahay Sheth	28	Mumbai	Computer Hardware Manufacturing Business	More than 2 times a week	Credit Card	Clicked nothing	Urgent Attention	54.2
9	Shivam shukla	31	Lucknow	Pooja items shop owner	More than 2 times a month	MF, SIP, FD, RD	Clicked nothing	Urgent Attention	57.2
10	Surendra Ganar	44	Nagpur	Sales officer	More than 2 times a month	UPI	Clicked nothing	Urgent Attention	58.6
11	Vikesh Mistry	39	Mumbai	Sr. Manager (Airport)	More than 2 times a week	Credit Card, FD, Insurance	Clicked nothing	Urgent Attention	56.2

Banking Landscape of participants



Most participants had more than one bank account other than their Axis Bank account.



Most participants also were using platforms like Angel One, Groww, Sharekhan, and Zerodha for investments.

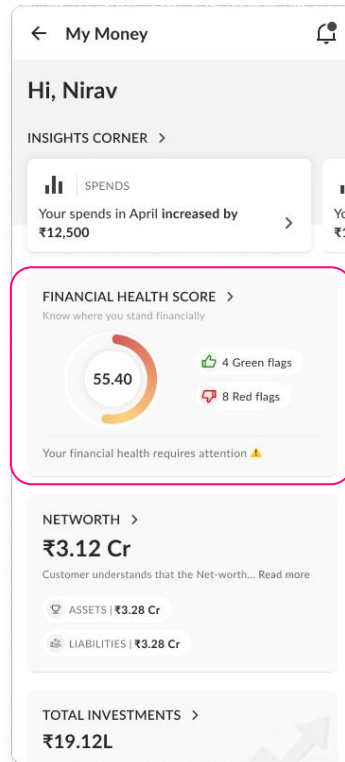
Experience of FHS

Activation of FHS

The score catches attention but does not peak interest due to lack of information about it.

- In fact participants that ignored the score after discovering My Money, did so because they didn't feel it was important.
 - They had stumbled upon My Money while they were trying to do some other banking task on the app and exit because they want to focus on it.

The '*Red flags*' tag and the microcopy below the score '*...requires attention*' provoke activation as users are concerned if there is something important they need to check.

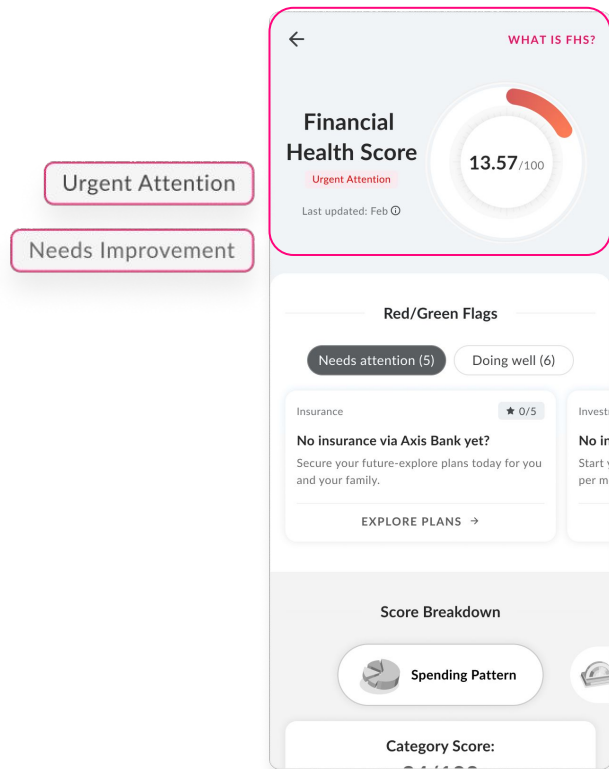


FHS CARD ON PFM LANDING PAGE

FHS Landing Page- Score section (1/2)

The nudge chip showing status of score is perceived as interactive as it looks like a button. It attracts attention due to its colour and participants click on it as they want to understand what requires *'Urgent Attention'* or *'Needs Improvement'*.

- The microcopy 'Last updated' is not readily visible or paid attention to as participants are unable to comment on update cadence when asked.
- However they gather this information if they discover the text button *'WHAT IS FHS'*.

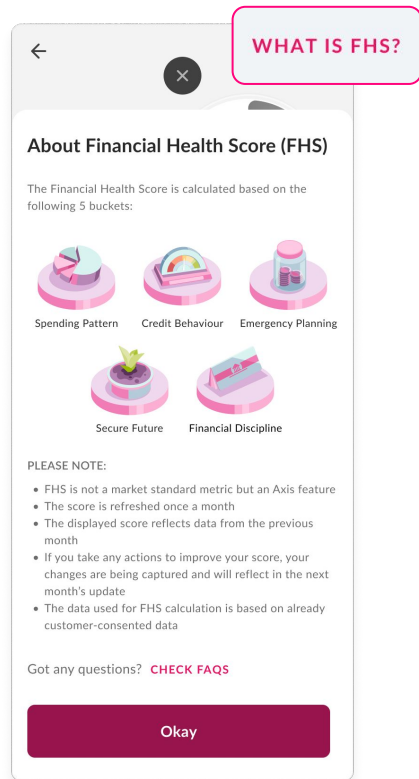


SCORE SECTION ELEMENTS
ON FHS LANDING PAGE

FHS Landing Page- Score section (2/2)

Participants tend to skim through the information in the bottom sheet than reading thoroughly (the bucket names more than the bullet points). They are able to match it to the bucket pills in Score Breakdown section and also get to know monthly update cadence.

- Noticing text button 'WHAT IS FHS'
 - Some participants that noticed the text button themselves did not necessarily open it as they felt they understood the feature and didn't need to know more.
 - Other participants (who did not notice by themselves) were able to locate the text button when probed where they can find more info about feature.



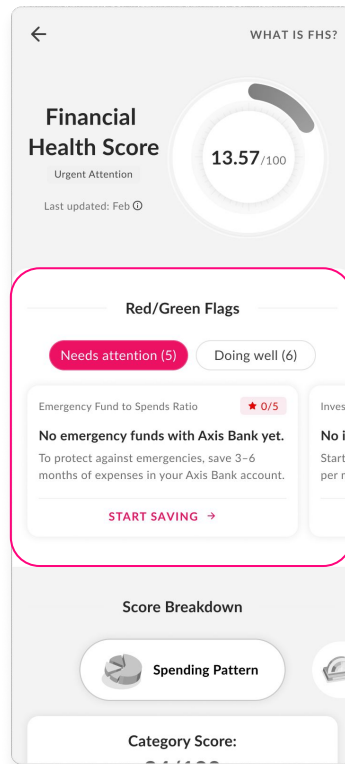
BOTTOM SHEET

FHS Landing Page- Flag section

Overall, the Flag section is understood well.

The heading of each card gets most attention. The part '*...with Axis Bank*' helps users understand that the feature/ score is considering finances only from Axis Bank. This influences their choice to interact further:

- Choice 1: Don't want to interact further as feature feels like a sales tactic forcing to invest via Axis Bank.
 - Choice 2: Swipe through rest of the cards to see if there's anything worth considering. But when most cards repeatedly display '*...with Axis Bank*', participants might not feel like exploring 'View All' as everything feels skewed towards Axis Bank usage.
-
- Most attention is on the Heading and Text Button. Rest elements in the card do not get attention and participants comment about it only on probing.
 - The expectation upon clicking any card's text button is to see direct recommendations rather than the general Investment Landing Page.
 - There are instances when participants tried clicking on the already selected pill as it looks like a button, hoping to see a list of items that 'need attention'.



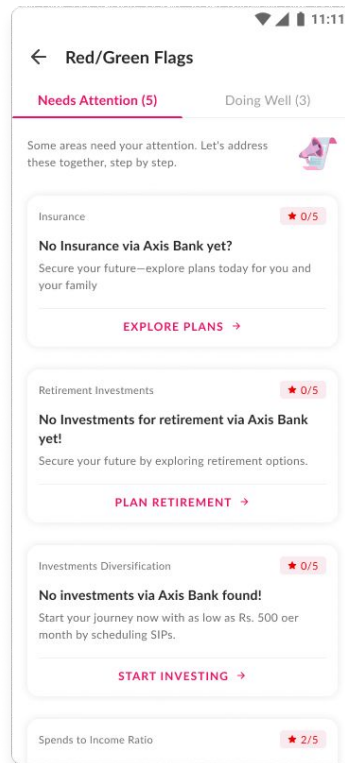
FLAG SECTION ON
FHS LANDING PAGE

FHS- Flag Page

Participants understand that this page is an expansion of the previous section since the flag cards repeat.

However while they read through the cards they do not want to take any action of investing as:

- they might already have those investments outside Axis Bank.
- the nudges feel sales-y due to heading copy like '*...via Axis Bank*'. Even if they like a certain nudge, they want to explore externally as there could be better alternatives.



FLAG PAGE IN FHS AFTER CLICKING 'VIEW ALL'

(Dis)engagement on the FHS Landing Page

Interacted

Reason(s)

1. Participants who had engaged with FHS earlier had explored the Flag section by clicking on the Card CTA or View All.
 - a. They interacted as they wanted further information to gauge if there was something very important to consider further.

Did Not Interact

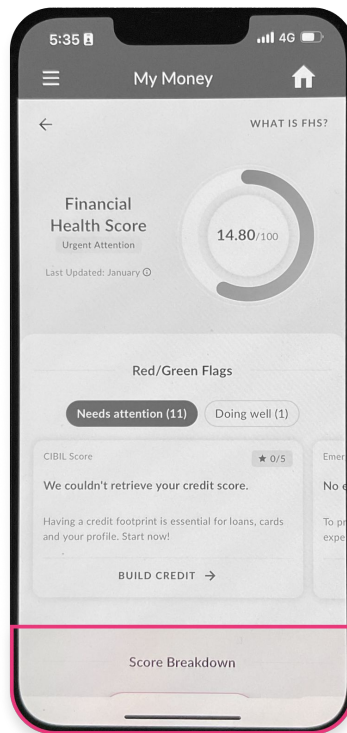
Reason(s)

1. Participants had toggled the flag pills or swiped through the flag carousel but exited because
 - a. either they understood that it is skewed to Axis Bank relationship due to the headings of the cards,
 - b. or it felt tedious to spend more time on the feature.
2. Others had interacted with a non-interactive element (score status nudge chip) and exited when nothing happened.

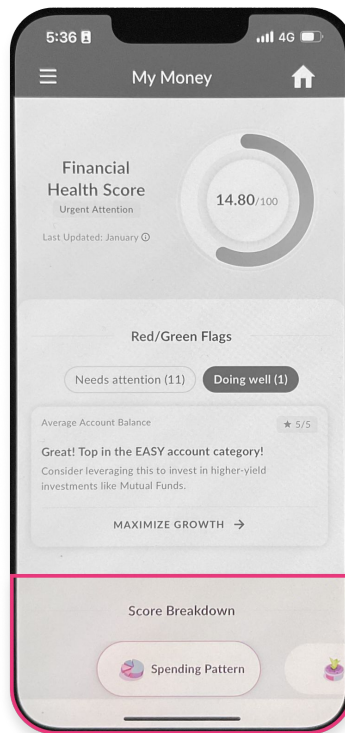
FHS Landing Page- Score Breakdown section

Participants often miss this section when they come to FHS Landing Page as they are more focused on the flag section and the Score Breakdown section is not visible (Scroll Position 1).

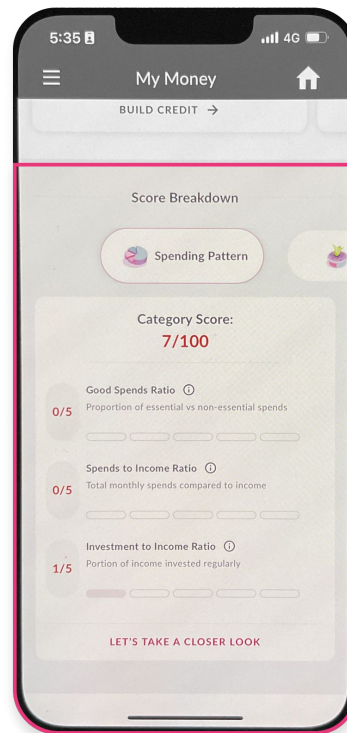
Those that scroll, exhibit different understandings based on how much of the next section is visible to them →



SCROLL POSITION 1:
ONLY SECTION TITLE VISIBLE



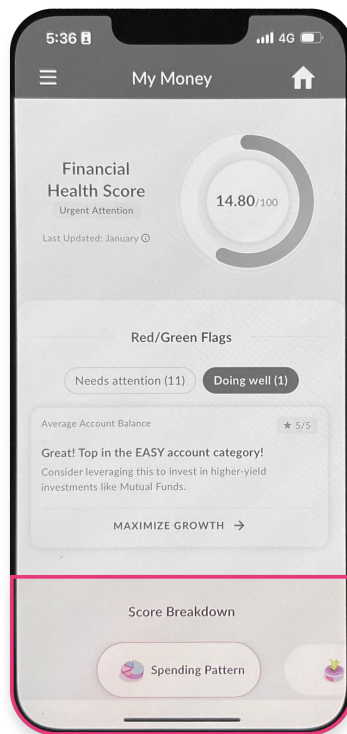
SCROLL POSITION 2:
ONLY BUCKET PILL VISIBLE



SCROLL POSITION 3:
PARTIAL OR FULL CARD VISIBLE

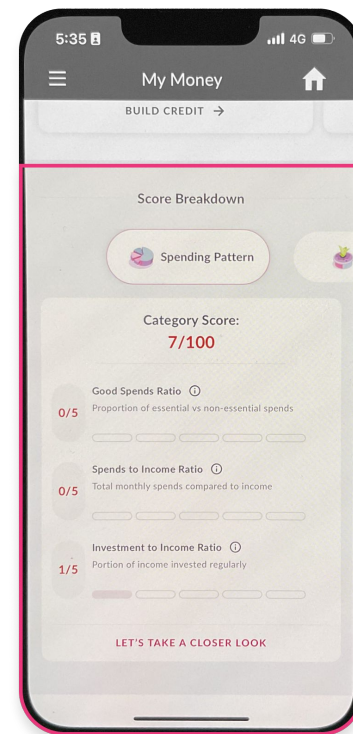
FHS Landing Page- Score Breakdown section

In Scroll Position 2, where only the bucket pill is visible, participants swipe on the carousel and scroll down.



SCROLL POSITION 2:
ONLY BUCKET PILL VISIBLE

In Scroll Position 2, where the card is partially or fully visible, participants focus more on the card ignoring the bucket carousel, which later hampers their understanding.



SCROLL POSITION 3:
PARTIAL OR FULL CARD VISIBLE

Score Breakdown section- Position 3

There's a disconnect between the Bucket Pill and the Card as participants perceive it as 2 separate sections.

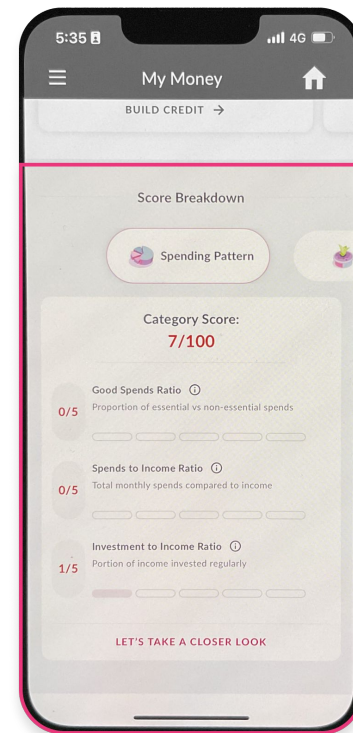
They correlate only if and when they observe that swiping on the buckets carousel changes the cards below them.

Perceive as Separate

- The bucket pill is perceived as a separate button that can be clicked to 'open' and get more information on their 'spending pattern'
- The card is treated as one section and participants perceive that the ratios are the categories for which the score is given.
- Hence they are able to deduce that the ratio score X/5 is correlated to the category score.

Perceive as Correlated

- Once they see and understand that the bucket carousel is related to the card, they also understand that there is correlation between the Ratio score, Category score and FHS shown at the top.



SCROLL POSITION 3:
PARTIAL OR FULL CARD VISIBLE

Score Breakdown section- Ratios (1/2)

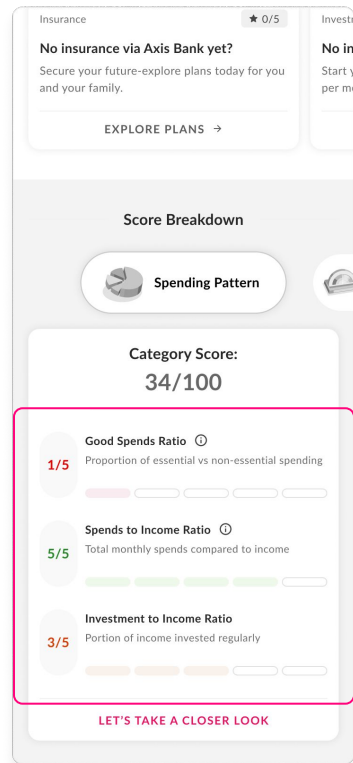
Higher comprehension of ratios

Such participants (might have higher financial literacy) are able to understand the ratio but express the need for more details or an example to understand how the section works to help judge if they agree with it or not.

- Since the ratio scores are out of 5 instead of 100 like the FHS or category score they can be misunderstood for quantity. Eg. 3 FDs are booked or 1 investment is done.

"Jaisa upar diya hai proportion of essential versus non-essential spending. Ab essential aur non-essential kaise justify kar raha hai, clarify kar raha hai, matlab kya kya iske stages hai woh nahi pata hai mere ko. Agar ek section mil jata ki aapke essential spending itne hai aur non-essential itne hai, toh main thoda usko control kar pata."

- 27 year old, Bilaspur, Salaried



RATIOS IN THE SCORE BREAKDOWN CARD

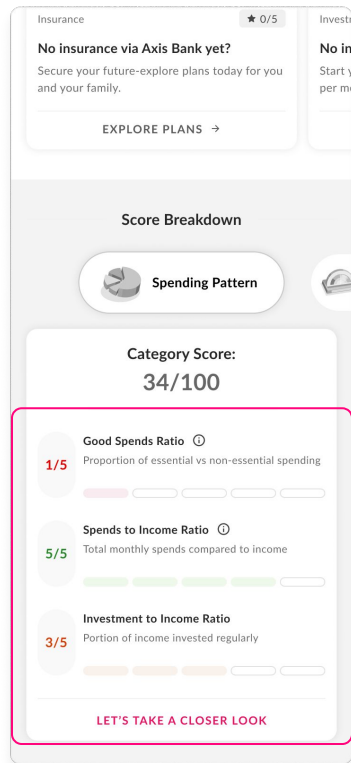
Score Breakdown section- Ratios (2/2)

Low comprehension of Ratios

Such participants tend to click on the ratio heading expecting it to open or provide more information on it.

- Due to repetitive clicking and fat finger phenomenon, the 'i' button might get pressed, opening the bottom sheet explaining the ratio.
- But the ratio explanation has low comprehension among participants who wait to skim through it while others close it immediately suggesting users' saturation with trying to read & understand anymore.

When all this does not help, they move to the text button '*Let's take a Closer look*' with the same expectation.



RATIOS IN THE SCORE BREAKDOWN CARD

FHS- All Actionables Page

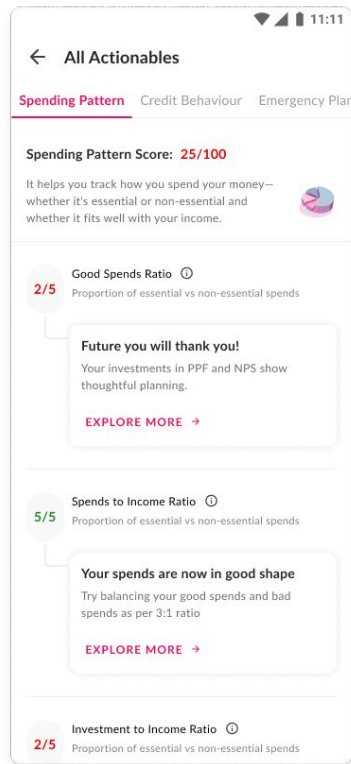
Participants understand that this page is an expansion of the previous section since the cards or copy repeat.

However while they read through the cards they do not want to take any action either because:

1. They might already have those investments outside Axis Bank
 2. They understand this screen from an interface pov, but the page is unable to provide them complete clarity. They feel the need to spend more time to understand why are they being suggested a specific instrument or how the suggestions will benefit them.
- After exploring the Actionables page, participants realise that investing as per suggestions will increase the Ratio and Category scores.
 - But since they do not know on what basis or how the scores are calculated, it reduces their interest in the 'score' aspect of the feature.

"It says 'debt to income ratio', but which kind of debt is this talking about? Also why would I take up secured debt just for the sake if I don't actually need a loan!"

- 28 year old, Mumbai



ALL ACTIONABLES PAGE

Agreement with Current Score

Do Not Agree

These participants are primarily those who have comparatively higher financial literacy.

They disagree as they feel score is inaccurate since it does not consider finances outside Axis Bank.

Partially Agree

They know that score is inaccurate as it omits finances outside Axis Bank but they agree with their score as it is in the higher half i.e. above 50.

They are also open to providing missing external data as they see value in knowing investment opportunities that they might have not considered yet.

Agree

They agree on face value (since their scores are in the higher half i.e. above 50) but they do not understand FHS completely.

A probable hypothesis is that they would not have agreed to the score if it was below 50-40.

Motivation to Revisit or Engage

Not at All

Reason(s)

1. These participants feel the score is inaccurate since it considers only Axis Bank finances.
2. The nudges/ suggestions provided to improve are also perceived as sales tactics, further lowering trust in the feature.

Partially

Reason(s)

1. These participants feel that FHS is best used to check opportunity gaps in their investment by scrolling through the flags.
2. But they will not necessarily act on them as better options might be available outside Axis Bank. They also understand that since score only considers Axis Bank finances, it may never improve.

User Mental Model

Financial Health: Mental Model (1/2)

LEVEL 1 DAY-TO-DAY STABILITY

The baseline definition of financial health for most users is simply that **income exceeds expenditure**. **Liquidity**, is non-negotiable here. Timely payments and managing debt also sit here, as they are seen as **hygiene, not aspiration**.

LEVEL 2 CONTROL & AWARENESS

Once stable, users shift to awareness and discipline. They track expenses, manage assets vs liabilities **consciously**. Users who operate at this layer feel "okay" or "average"; **they're not worried, but they're not growing either**.

LEVEL 3 FUTURE SECURITY THROUGH GROWTH

The top layer is about building toward the future where users have **moved from being reactive to proactive**. They also tend to have higher financial literacy. **Diversification across instruments** and asset classes is how they measure whether they're doing well.

Financial Health: Mental Model (2/2)

Thinking about Financial Health is **event-triggered, not continuous**. Ex. salary credit, or a financial windfall/ shortfall for business owners.

Users across life stages and occupations have **varied financial situations** and thus have different financial goals.

Financial relations span multiple banks and platforms. A score informed using only a specific dataset does not feel reliable.

CIBIL is a mental reference point. It has a **threshold**, a **consequence**, and **credibility** which users expect from FHS.

- While the score draws initial attention it is not what users are interested in because a score is not their actual financial health.
- Improving the score is not the goal, their growth is. Hence they want to pay attention to the flags & suggestions more.

"See score is not important. What all products you are offering on your platform, that's more important. Your score cannot determine because see you don't know what sort of investments I have. You are not connecting all my assets!"

- 34 year old, Mumbai, Business Owner

User Needs (1/3)

Need

- Accuracy & Transparency of Score

Frustrations

- Since external finances are omitted, red flags are not concerning and score is inaccurate.

Expectations

- Users want to know the calculations & logic on which the score is based so that the investment suggestions can be seen as accurate information.

User Suggestions

- Improve score logic by including holistic finances so that the analysis can be accurate. Eg. if a credit card is used to pay insurance premium, is it mapped as a positive behaviour or negative one.

"Debt to income ratio... Debt! Mera debt kis me hai bhai? Asset liability zero. Credit card ka zero. External liabilities... hai nahi kuch. Meri toh debt hai hi nahi. Your debt is over 3x of which is typical income for people like you. Isme ek ye hai click karne ke liye ki reduce debt karke. Lekin mera toh koi debt hai hi nahi matlab koi loan mera chal hi nahi raha hai."

- 27 year old, Bilaspur, Salaried

User Needs (2/3)

Need

- Trusted, Conclusive Guidance

Frustrations

- Suggestions cannot be trusted if they are in favour of the bank and not the user. Users need to know what's the benefit for them, apart from just increasing the score (since it has no credibility unlike CIBIL).

Expectations

- Users expect more useful info (maybe examples, explanations, reasons) to inform their investment opportunities confidently.

User Suggestions

- Personalised recommendations instead of just analysis as most are aware about the different instruments but hesitate to invest. Additionally pros/cons or alternatives can help make the most suitable decision.

"If you ask me, I started my journey with FD and RDs. It's a traditional system and one of the safest but nowadays I don't think so it plays a vital role. You hardly earn around 6-7% nowadays on interest. So it's better you go for something like an ELSS saving schemes where you would be getting good returns, or maybe go for debt mutual funds which at least gives around 10 to 11% minimum on the side. I'm earning 3% extra out there. So make investments which give you good fruitful returns in the end."

- 34 year old, Mumbai, Business Owner

User Needs (3/3)

Need

- A Simpler System

Frustrations

- Currently the feature is perceived as time-taking for deep self exploration due to the nested architecture with similar information repeating across multiple sections.

Expectations

- Users expect a quicker and easier way to understand the feature and its information to reduce cognitive load.
- If investment nudges are based on score updates, opportunities should be notified at the right time.

User Suggestions

- Easier consumption through improved UI like graphs instead of texts, rearranging sections, or ensuring elements are interactive if they look like it.

"All this should come upfrontly (maybe from my RM) rather than a customer diving deep. See we don't have time to explore the whole page or whole app. I check only my account balance, transactions, credit card bill. That's it. Somewhere I feel like bahut saari cheezein ho rahi hai aur bahut saari cheezon ke liye you want some guide or facilitator who guides you, who motivates you who helps you...so that at least you can be on the right track or follow the right steps."

- 39 year old, Mumbai, Salaried



Thank You